兴登堡号的 34 秒

The Last Flight of the Hindenburg



一场被拍下的大火，怎样终结了飞艇客运时代？

英文原文

In 1936 the **colossal** Hindenburg made 17 Atlantic **round trips**, a **marvel** of **luxury** and **glamour**. Its **amenities** included a **lounge** and, that year, a grand piano. An American **embargo** on **helium export** had left the ship relying on **hydrogen**. Because that gas was **combustible**, **smokers sat behind** an airlock with one **electric lighter**.

The **airship** left Frankfurt on 3 May 1937. Hours behind its **timetable**, it met **thunderstorms** at Lakehurst and **circled** for over an hour **before** its **descent** towards the **mooring mast**. At about 7:25 pm on 6 May, **flames** appeared near the **stern**. The **inferno incinerated** the ship in about half a minute, leaving a **crumpled frame**.

Of the 97 aboard, 62 survived, a **proportion** close to **two-thirds**, while **a minority of** 35 died, as did one man on the ground. A 14-year-old **cabin boy** was **drenched** by a **deluge** from a **burst** water tank, and the **soaking** saved him. He dropped through a **hatch** and **scrambled** clear, escaping only **narrowly**.

Newsreel cameras and **photographers** caught the disaster. A radio **correspondent**'s **eyewitness commentary** was not live; **audiences** heard it the next day. The cause has not been **definitively** established, but **static electricity igniting leaking** hydrogen is the **leading explanation**. A **theory** blaming the **doped fabric** has been **rejected**.

The 1933 crash of USS Akron killed 73 yet won less **notoriety**. The filmed fire left a **fateful image** that **abruptly** wrecked **confidence**. As public **perception soured**, Graf Zeppelin was **withdrawn**, later **scrapped**, and a **glamorous epoch** of **aviation** closed. The **doomed** airship's first journey to North America had begun on 6 May 1936, exactly a year before the fire.

中文译文

1936年，巨大的兴登堡号完成了17次跨大西洋往返飞行，这是一个奢华与魅力的奇观。它的便利设施包括一间休息厅，以及，在那一年，一架三角钢琴。美国对氦气出口的禁运已经使得这艘飞艇只能依赖于氢气。因为氢气易燃，吸烟者只能坐在一道带有电子点烟器的气闸后面。

1937年5月3日，飞艇离开法兰克福。它比时刻表晚了几个小时，在莱克赫斯特遇到雷暴，盘旋了一个多小时，才开始朝着系留塔架下降。5月6日晚上约7点25分，火焰出现在了飞艇的尾部附近。这场无法控制的大火在大约半分钟内就焚毁了这艘飞艇，留下了一副扭曲变形的骨架。

在艇上97人中，62人生还，这一比例接近三分之二；而少数的35人遇难，地面上另有一名男子也丧生了。一名14岁的艇上的服务生被一个爆裂的水箱里涌出的水浇透了，而正是这一身湿透救了他。他从一个舱口掉落下去，迅速而吃力地爬了出来，仅仅勉强逃脱。

新闻纪录片摄影机和摄影师拍下了这场灾难。一位电台的专题记者的目击实况报道并不是直播；听众在第二天才听到。起火原因尚未清楚地得到确认，但静电点燃泄漏的氢气是最主要的解释。一种将责任归咎于上过涂料的蒙皮织物的未被证实的看法，并没有被接受。

1933年阿克伦号失事造成73人死亡，恶名却没那么大。被拍下的大火留下了一幅带来厄运的画面，骤然摧毁了人们的信心。随着公众的看法变糟，格拉夫·齐柏林号退役，随后被报废处理，而航空业的一个充满魅力的时代结束了。这艘注定毁灭的飞艇首次飞往北美的航程，始于1936年5月6日，恰好是那场大火的一年前。

词汇与表达

colossal adj.
巨大的
the colossal Hindenburg

round trips n.
往返飞行

marvel n.
奇观

luxury n.
奢华

glamour n.
魅力

amenities n.
便利设施
Its amenities included a lounge

lounge n.
休息厅

embargo n.
禁运
An American embargo on helium export

helium n.
氦气

export n.
出口

hydrogen n.
氢气

combustible adj.
易燃
that gas was combustible

smokers n.
吸烟者

sat behind v.
坐在……后面

electric lighter n.
电子点烟器

airship n.
飞艇

timetable n.
时刻表

thunderstorms n.
雷暴

circled v.
盘旋了

before conj.
才开始

descent n.
下降
its descent towards the mooring mast

mooring mast n.
系留塔架
towards the mooring mast

flames n.
火焰

词汇与表达（续）

stern n.
尾部
near the stern

inferno n.
无法控制的大火
The inferno incinerated the ship

incinerated v.
焚毁了
The inferno incinerated the ship

crumpled adj.
扭曲变形的
leaving a crumpled frame

frame n.
骨架

a minority of phr.
少数的

proportion n.
比例
a proportion close to two-thirds

two-thirds n.
三分之二

cabin boy n.
艇上的服务生

drenched adj.
浇透了
was drenched by a deluge

deluge n.
涌出的水
a deluge from a burst water tank

burst v.
爆裂的

soaking n.
湿透

hatch n.
舱口
He dropped through a hatch

scrambled v.
迅速而吃力地爬了

narrowly adv.
勉强

photographers n.
摄影师

correspondent n.
专题记者
A radio correspondent's

eyewitness n.
目击
eyewitness commentary was not live

commentary n.
实况报道
eyewitness commentary was not live

词汇与表达（续）

audiences n.
听众

definitively adv.
清楚地
has not been definitively established

static electricity n.
静电
static electricity igniting

igniting v.
点燃

leaking adj.
泄漏的

leading explanation phr.
最主要的解释
is the leading explanation

theory n.
未被证实的看法

doped adj.
上过涂料的

fabric n.
蒙皮织物

rejected v.
没有被接受

notoriety n.
恶名

fateful adj.
带来厄运的

image n.
画面

abruptly adv.
骤然

confidence n.
信心

perception n.
看法
As public perception soured

soured v.
变糟

withdrawn v.
退役

scrapped v.
报废处理

glamorous adj.
充满魅力的

epoch n.
时代
a glamorous epoch of aviation

aviation n.
航空业

doomed adj.
注定毁灭的

文章简述

- 隐患：兴登堡号是豪华跨洋飞艇；美国禁运氦气，使它只能靠易燃氢气浮空，留下安全隐患。
- 失事：1937年5月6日，它在美国降落、准备停靠地面塔架时尾部起火，约半分钟就烧成扭曲骨架。
- 伤亡：艇上97人中62人生还、35人遇难；地面另有1人死亡，遇难者合计36人。
- 原因：火因尚无定论，主要解释是静电点燃泄漏氢气；归咎外层布料涂层的说法被否定。
- 落幕：1933年另一飞艇事故死73人，却不及兴登堡号出名；这次影像和次日播出的现场录音重创信心，飞艇客运时代落幕。